



Website Accessibility Compliance Report

WCAG 2.1 Level AA Audit & Remediation

Prepared for	All Phase Plumbing — Tukwila, WA
Website	allphaseplumbing.com (88 pages)
Standard	WCAG 2.1, Conformance Levels A & AA
Audit engine	axe-core 4.x (Deque Systems) — industry standard
Report date	July 3, 2026
Prepared by	EthixWeb — info@ethixweb.com

FINAL RESULT: 0 WCAG 2.1 AA VIOLATIONS ACROSS ALL 88 PAGES

1. Executive Summary

The All Phase Plumbing website was audited against the **Web Content Accessibility Guidelines (WCAG) 2.1, Level AA** — the standard referenced in virtually all ADA website-accessibility claims in the United States. The audit used the same automated testing engine (axe-core) that powers the scanning tools commonly used to identify targets for accessibility demand letters and lawsuits.

The initial scan found **1,577 rule violations across 82 of the site's 88 pages**, including 76 critical form-field failures. All issues were traced to their root causes in the site's code and corrected. A full re-audit of every page, on both desktop and mobile layouts, now reports **zero WCAG 2.1 A/AA violations**.

	Before Remediation	After Remediation
Pages scanned	88	88 (x2 viewports = 176 scans)
Pages with violations	82	0
Violation instances	1,577	0
Critical issues	76	0
Scan engine	axe-core 4.x	axe-core 4.x

2. Why This Matters

Businesses across the country — including many in Washington State — are receiving demand letters and lawsuits claiming their websites are inaccessible to users with disabilities under the Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA). These claims are almost always built on the output of automated accessibility scanners: the plaintiff runs a scan, and every failed check becomes cited evidence.

The most effective protection is for those same scans to come back clean. This remediation targeted exactly that: every page of the site now passes the full WCAG 2.1 A/AA automated ruleset. Genuine code-level fixes were applied — no third-party “accessibility overlay” widgets were used, as overlays do not fix the underlying code that scanners test and have repeatedly failed to prevent litigation (over 20% of accessibility lawsuits in recent years targeted sites already using an overlay).

3. Audit Methodology

- **Engine:** axe-core 4.x by Deque Systems — the most widely used accessibility rules engine, embedded in Google Lighthouse, axe DevTools and most commercial scanning services.

- **Ruleset:** WCAG 2.1 Conformance Levels A and AA (tags wcag2a, wcag2aa, wcag21a, wcag21aa).
- **Coverage:** all 88 pages — home, services (60+), commercial, residential, 21 city service-area pages, blog and articles, coupons, about, and contact.
- **Viewports:** every page scanned twice — desktop (1366px) and mobile (390px) — because some interface elements only exist in the mobile layout.
- **Animation handling:** scans run with reduced-motion emulation so content revealed by scroll animations is fully evaluated rather than skipped — deeper coverage than a standard scan.
- **Process:** baseline audit → root-cause fixes in code → full re-audit → repeat until zero violations remained.

4. What Was Found

All 1,577 violation instances traced back to a small number of repeating root causes in shared page templates:

Issue	Severity	Instances	Plain-English meaning
Insufficient color contrast	Serious	1,434	Light blue, gold and low-opacity text on light or similar-tone backgrounds was below the legal readability thresholds (4.5:1 / 3:1) for low-vision users.
Form fields without labels	Critical	76	The “Service Needed” dropdown on quote forms had no label a screen reader could announce — a blind visitor could not tell what the field was for. This is the most commonly cited issue in ADA web demand letters.
Invalid screen-reader markup	Serious	66	Star-rating graphics on the 21 city pages used ARIA labels in a way assistive technology cannot interpret.
Hidden menu still keyboard-reachable	Serious	—	The mobile services menu, while closed, could still be reached with the keyboard, trapping focus on invisible controls.
Scrollable list not keyboard-accessible	Serious	1	The city list on the contact page could be scrolled with a mouse but not with a keyboard.

Note: a standard single-pass scan reports roughly 1,000 of these instances. The remaining ~577 were uncovered by this audit's deeper passes (mobile layout and animation-revealed content) — issues a plaintiff's scanner could also find, now also resolved.

5. What Was Fixed

- **Readable color palette:** all failing text colors were adjusted to meet or exceed WCAG contrast ratios while preserving the brand's navy / blue / gold design. The changes are visually subtle — slightly deeper shades of the same colors.
- **Accessible forms:** every quote-form dropdown across the site now carries a proper accessible label announced by screen readers.
- **Screen-reader semantics:** star ratings now use valid image roles; decorative animations are hidden from assistive technology.
- **Full keyboard support:** the mobile services menu is sealed off from keyboard focus while closed; the coupons side panel now opens on keyboard focus; the contact-page city list is keyboard-scrollable with a visible focus indicator.
- **Reduced-motion support:** all scroll-reveal animations now respect the user's “reduce motion” system setting — content appears instantly for motion-sensitive users, which is also an accessibility best practice in its own right.

6. Verification of Results

After remediation, every page was re-scanned on both desktop and mobile layouts — 176 scans in total. Result:

Scans executed	176 (88 pages × 2 viewports)
WCAG 2.1 A/AA violations found	0
Pages failing	0

A permanent, re-runnable audit tool has been installed in the website's codebase. Any future site update can be re-verified against the full WCAG 2.1 AA ruleset in minutes, so compliance can be maintained as the site evolves.

7. Recommended Next Steps

- **Publish an Accessibility Statement page** stating the site's WCAG 2.1 AA target and offering a phone/email contact for anyone who has difficulty using the site. Attorneys consistently regard this as strong evidence of good faith.
- **Re-scan after deployment** to confirm the live production site matches these results (this audit was performed on the current development copy of the site).
- **Re-run the audit after significant content or design changes**, using the tooling installed with this engagement.
- **Optional:** a manual assistive-technology review (screen reader / keyboard-only walkthrough of the quote flow) covers the portion of WCAG that automated tools cannot test.

8. Scope & Disclaimer

This report reflects the state of the All Phase Plumbing website as of July 3, 2026, measured against the automated WCAG 2.1 Level A/AA ruleset (axe-core 4.x). Automated testing covers the substantial majority of issues cited in accessibility claims, but no automated tool can evaluate every WCAG success criterion, and no audit constitutes a guarantee against litigation or a certification of legal compliance. Third-party embedded content (e.g., Google reCAPTCHA) is maintained by its vendor and is outside the site's code. Future changes to the site should be re-verified using the installed audit tooling.